

Firearms Trace Data: Arizona - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Contents

1. [ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer](#)
2. [Table: Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Arizona in Calendar Year 2023](#)
3. [Table: Firearm Types with an Arizona Recovery](#)
4. [Table: Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arizona Recovery](#)
5. [Table: Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arizona Recovery](#)
6. [Table: Top 15 Source States for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery](#)
7. [Table: Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery](#)
8. [Table: Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery](#)
9. [Table: Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery](#)
10. [Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics](#)

ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Arizona in Calendar Year 2023

13,927

Firearm Types with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	10,300
Rifles	1,729
Revolvers	708
Shotguns	688
Machineguns	179
Machinegun Conversion Devices	159
Other*	164

*Other includes Receivers/Frames, Derringers, Unknown Types, Silencers, Combinations, a Destructive Device, and a Flare Gun.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	6,199
.40 Cal	1,172
.22 Cal	969
.45 Cal	881
.380 Cal	730

12GA	577
7.62mm	565
5.56mm	463
.38 Cal	297
MULTI	233

NOTE: There were 1,380 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 461 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	3,448
Possession of Weapon	1,864
Weapon Offense	1,813
Dangerous Drugs	1,172
Aggravated Assault	900
Found Firearm	844
Health - Safety	583
Weapons Trafficking	384
Homicide	374
Family Offense	372

NOTE: There were 2,173 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Arizona	9,664
California	237
Texas	213
New Mexico	129
Washington	97
Colorado	90
Florida	89
Nevada	86
Georgia	53
Indiana	48
Missouri	48
Oregon	46
Utah	45
Michigan	43
Illinois	39

NOTE: An additional 34 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 642 other traces. The source state was identified in 11,569 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	1,325
3 Months to Under 7 Months	949
7 Months to Under 1 Year	933
1 Year to Under 2 Years	1,665
2 Years to Under 3 Years	1,592
3 Years and Over	5,089

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Arizona Average Time-to-Crime: **5.64 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	320
18 to 21	1,098
22 to 24	730
25 to 30	1,309
31 to 40	1,851
41 to 50	1,220
Over 50	917

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Arizona Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Phoenix	4,640
Tucson	2,250
Glendale	1,012
Mesa	783
Tempe	767
Scottsdale	461
Yuma	282
Chandler	245
Peoria	235
Goodyear	220

NOTE: There were 164 additional municipalities that accounted for 3,027 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for five traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Arizona. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Arizona.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with an Arizona Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Arizona Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Arizona Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024